

Oghenevovwe Ikumariiegbe

Department of Computer Science, University of Arizona
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Education

Ph.D. in Computer Science

2022 - Present

University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ
Minor: Cognitive Science
Advisor: Dr. Eduardo Blanco

B.S. in Informatics and Computer Engineering

2021

National Research University "Moscow Power Engineering Institute, Russia
Degree with Honors, GPA:4.0

Publications

2025 **Oghenevovwe Ikumariiegbe**, Eduardo Blanco, and Ellen Riloff. 2025. Studying Rhetorically Ambiguous Questions. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, pages 30519–30529, Suzhou, China.

Enfa Fane, Md Nayem Uddin, **Oghenevovwe Ikumariiegbe**, Daniyal Kashif, Eduardo Blanco, and Steven Corman. 2025. BEMEAE: Moving Beyond Exact Span Match for Event Argument Extraction. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, pages 5734–5749, Albuquerque, New Mexico.

Research Experience

UA Department of Computer Science (Tucson, AZ)

Graduate Researcher / Research Assistant

2022 – Present

- Investigating nuance in claims for automated claim verification.
- Developing methods to detect nuanced claims and dynamically route them to specialized verification systems.
- Evaluating whether the claim-type routing improves verification accuracy on highly nuanced claims.
- Curated a dataset in pragmatic NLP research for studying real-world rhetorical ambiguity.
- Evaluated prompted and fine-tuned LLMs on the dataset, demonstrating the increased complexity of the dataset relative to existing benchmarks.

- Contributed to event argument extraction research that introduced a novel evaluation metric that goes beyond exact span match and aligns more closely with human judgement.

Funding:

Graduate Research Assistant — Jan 2024 – May 2025

Teaching Experience

Instructor, UA Department of Computer Science

Summer 2023

Discrete Mathematics for Computer Science I

Teaching Assistant, UA Department of Computer Science

Spring 2026

Web Programming

Fall 2025

Comparative Programming Languages

Fall 2022 – Fall 2023

Web Programming

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, JavaScript, C++

NLP and ML: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face Transformers, fine-tuning, model evaluation, data augmentation, preprocessing, and analysis

Tools: Git, Linux

Service

- Reviewer, European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL) Demo Track, 2026
- Virtual Volunteer, Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2025
- Reviewer, EMNLP 2025 System Demonstrations Track, 2025
- Graduate Student Council Member, Department of Computer Science, University of Arizona, 2022 – 2023